

How to get the installer (.exe)

Important honesty note: This repository contains the complete **source code** plus everything needed to produce the installer. The compiled installer itself (`NotificationReader_Setup.exe`) is **not** included, because a Windows WPF + WinRT + MSIX app can **only be compiled on Windows** — it cannot be built on Linux/Mac. Below are three ways to turn this source into a real installer, easiest first.

✓ Option 1 — Let GitHub build it for you (no Visual Studio needed)

This is the easiest path if you don't want to install anything.

1. Create a new **GitHub** repository and push this folder to it:

```
bash
git init                # (already done for you)
git add -A && git commit -m "initial"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/<you>/notificationreader.git
git push -u origin main
```

2. On GitHub, open the **Actions** tab. The workflow **"Build Windows Installer"** runs automatically. (You can also click **Run workflow** manually.)
3. Wait ~5 minutes. Open the finished run and download the artifact **NotificationReader-Setup** — it contains **NotificationReader_Setup.exe**.
4. Bonus: push a tag and GitHub also creates a **Release** with the installer attached:

```
bash
git tag v1.0.0 && git push origin v1.0.0
```

A free Microsoft-hosted **Windows** runner does all the compiling. You just download the result.

🖥️ Option 2 — Build it yourself on a Windows 11 PC (one command)

Requirements (install once):

- **.NET 8 SDK** — <https://dotnet.microsoft.com/download/dotnet/8.0>
- **Visual Studio 2022** (or Build Tools) with the .NET desktop and Universal Windows Platform / MSIX packaging workloads
- **Inno Setup 6** — <https://jrsoftware.org/isinfo.php>

Then, from this folder in PowerShell:

```
.\build.ps1
```

Your installer appears at:

```
installer_output\NotificationReader_Setup.exe
```

Double-click it to install. It handles the certificate, installs the app, and adds a Start-Menu shortcut automatically.



Option 3 — Open in Visual Studio

1. Open `NotificationReader.sln`, set platform to **x64**.
2. Set **NotificationReader.Package** as the startup project.
3. **Publish** → **Create App Packages...** → **Sideload** to produce the `.msix`.
4. Run `.\build.ps1` (or Inno Setup on `installer.iss`) to wrap it into `Setup.exe`.

Why can't you just give me the .exe directly?

The assistant that generated this project runs on **Linux**. Building a Windows desktop app that uses:

- **WPF / Windows Forms** (Windows-only UI frameworks),
- **WinRT APIs** (`UserNotificationListener`, `SpeechSynthesizer`), and
- **MSIX packaging** (required so the app gets the package identity that the notification-listener API demands),

requires the **Windows** build toolchain (MSBuild + Windows SDK + packaging targets). None of that exists or runs on Linux, so no Windows binary can be produced here. **Option 1 above is the closest thing to “just give me the exe”** — GitHub's Windows servers compile it for free and you download the finished file.